

PREMIUM

Refusal Decision Guide

Why there's no Tribunal appeal, and what actually changes the outcome

Understand your options after a refusal

Outcome	What it means	What you can do
Refusal	INZ wasn't satisfied you're a genuine temporary visitor, or a specific requirement (funds, health, character) wasn't met.	Generally no statutory appeal for a standard Visitor Visa refusal - see below for what's actually available.
Complaint to the Ombudsman	If you believe the decision process itself was unfair or unreasonable (not simply that you disagree with the outcome).	A genuine but limited avenue - it reviews process and fairness, not a full merits reassessment.
Judicial review	A legal challenge in the New Zealand courts, on legal-error or procedural-fairness grounds only, not a fresh look at the merits.	A genuine legal process, generally worth professional immigration legal advice.
Reapplication	A new application, assessed fresh.	Usually the fastest and most practical path if something material has actually changed.

Why there's no Tribunal appeal here

The Immigration and Protection Tribunal (IPT) - New Zealand's specialist immigration appeal body - primarily hears residence-class and deportation matters. A standard, temporary Visitor Visa refusal generally isn't within its jurisdiction, which is a genuinely more restrictive position than the review or appeal mechanisms available for most other countries in this catalogue.

What actually helps

- Read your refusal letter for the exact reason given, and address that specific point directly in a reapplication
- If funds were the issue, strengthen your evidence against INZ's specific per-month guideline, or arrange a proper INZ 1025 Sponsorship Form
- If genuine-visitor intent was the issue, make your itinerary and ties to home more specific and better evidenced

What not to do

- Don't reapply immediately with an unchanged application
- Don't omit a previous refusal on a later application
- Don't submit materially false information to work around a previous refusal

When to seek professional advice

Consider consulting a licensed New Zealand immigration adviser or lawyer if you're considering judicial review, or if you've been refused multiple times despite genuinely strengthening your case.